



## THE BANDS OF ASHLEY HIGH SCHOOL

Wilmington, North Carolina · ashleybands.com

## RECOGNIZED STATEWIDE PROGRAM OF DISTINCTION

Inaugural class · 2025-2026  
North Carolina Bandmasters Association

CIVIC BRIEF | SEPTEMBER 2026

# NEW HANOVER COUNTY AT *Carnegie Hall*.

About 100 Eugene Ashley High School student musicians will represent New Hanover County and the City of Wilmington on the stage of Carnegie Hall on March 25, 2027. Six years ago this program was down to about 52 students, rehearsing outside in masks. Their selection places this community among the recognized leaders in American music education.

### THE NUMBERS

**STUDENTS PERFORMING  
ABOUT 100**

**PERFORMANCE DATE  
MARCH 25, 2027**

**VENUE  
CARNEGIE HALL, NEW  
YORK CITY**

**TRAVEL DATES  
MARCH 23-26, 2027**

**CAMPAIGN GOAL  
\$250,000**

### THE CREDENTIAL

Ashley High School's Concert Band and Wind Ensemble submitted recordings and were selected through the festival's application process. Both bands were selected. Separately, the program was named to the inaugural class of the NCBA Program of Distinction, a statewide recognition in its first year. These are two separate achievements from the same program. New Hanover County Schools produced both.

### THE CAMPAIGN

A \$250,000 community campaign is underway so that no student has to miss this because of money. Civic leadership has an opportunity to demonstrate public investment in educational excellence. Donation portal: [ashleybands.com/support-carnegie](https://ashleybands.com/support-carnegie).

### CIVIC ENGAGEMENT OPPORTUNITIES

- + Formal proclamation at County Commission, City Council, or Board of Education
- + Public statement of support from elected or appointed officials
- + Introductions to businesses and civic organizations for sponsorship
- + Congressional recognition through Rep. Rouzer's office

**The lasting result** is not the performance itself. It is what these students bring back: musical confidence, stronger ensemble habits, and a raised sense of what is possible for every student who comes after them through this program.

### KEY CONTACTS

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